



The role of extracurricular sports activities in protecting students from violence and social problems and promoting physical health in the school environment

Raouan Mohamed

University of laghout (Algeria)

m.raouan@lagh-univ.dz

Abstract ;

The purpose of this study is to understand how school sports can contribute to reducing violence, whether verbal, physical or symbolic, as well as social problems such as smoking, drug abuse and maintaining physical health in schools. To achieve this, a questionnaire containing 24 questions was prepared for secondary school physical education and sports teachers. After conducting a statistical analysis of the answers, it was found that school sports have significant benefits, as they allow students to invest their free time in a way that meets their interests as well as the interests of society and the environment. Therefore, school sports contribute to meeting students' social and psychological needs, such as the desire to make friends, enhance self-esteem, and help them cope with anxiety problems and psychological disorders.

Article info

Received

November 21.2025

Accepted

January 08.2026

Keyword:

- ✓ Verbal violence
- ✓ physical violence
- ✓ symbolic violence
- ✓ school sports
- ✓ social ills

1/The problem

Education in its broadest sense means all efforts made to bring about a desired change in the behavior of members of society. The correct educational methods to which an individual is exposed are considered a bulwark that protects him from slipping into various social problems such as the dangers of drug abuse. Therefore, the role of the school as an educational institution responsible for raising and preparing children becomes important, as it comes second after the family. Through school, children learn their values, principles and behavior patterns. The school can take measures and programs to ensure the protection of children from drug abuse, and plays an important role among the means of socialization in society.

The results of a school study conducted by the National Narcotics Control Authority showed that the rate of drug abuse in schools has witnessed a significant increase in recent years, revealing that about 54,000 students use drugs in educational settings. Results collected from 426 middle and high schools nationwide (*April 17-21, 2016*) showed that more than 8. 5% of students smoke shisha, and 1. 95% drink alcohol, and 1. 87% use hallucinogens, and 0. 42% use cocaine, and 0. 33% are addicted to heroin. In addition, the problems of the school environment are not limited to drugs alone, but also include the phenomena of

violence in its various forms, such as physical, verbal, and symbolic violence.

The causes of this violence are multiple, as those who practice it sometimes suffer from psychological pressures related to deprivation, which is a feeling resulting from the failure to fulfill certain desires, whether material or moral. Frustration, which many researchers associate with violence, can lead to increased aggressive behavior as a result of stressors experienced at multiple developmental stages, especially adolescence. Others also argue that jealousy, a common emotional feeling among students, contributes to violence, which manifests itself in the form of rebellion and criticism. Due to the feeling of inferiority or inferiority resulting from the fear of failure, the school environment is affected. There are also social factors related to the family or the school itself that cause these problems.

Based on the premise that the school is responsible for confronting the phenomenon of social ills and increasing violence, voices have been raised demanding the necessity of the school carrying out various activities, whether inside or outside the classroom, such as sports and cultural activities. Outdoor sports activities are a key component of the country's educational policy, serving as a pillar of a student-centered sports movement in schools.

This activity is not limited to participating in competitions, but includes any recreational activity organized by the school. According to researcher Patrick Seners, this activity represents the efforts of sports associations within the educational institution and according to agreed-upon rules. It raises questions about its effectiveness in combating social ills and preserving students' physical health. How can it also contribute to the prevention of drug abuse and cigarette consumption? What is its role in promoting physical health in general?

Hypotheses

General hypothesis

Extracurricular sports activity has a positive impact in protecting students from social problems and maintaining their physical health while they practice various school sports.

Partial hypotheses

- Extracurricular sports activity can help reduce the risk of drug abuse in schools;
- Extracurricular sports activity contributes to reducing smoking among students;
- Sports activity has a positive impact in promoting the physical health of students who engage in various types of school sports activities.

Study objectives

The primary goal of this study is to understand the actual role that extracurricular sports activities play in educational institutions in preventing some of the social challenges prevailing among school students, and to highlight the positive impact of these activities on practitioners and the extent of their impact on maintaining their physical health.

The importance of the study

From the scientific side:

The scientific findings of this study can be used to highlight the importance of school sports and its various benefits for students: educational, formative, and recreational.

- Working to reach a comprehensive understanding of the positive roles played by school sports from the social and educational perspectives, and their preventive and health impact.

From the practical side:

Providing a comprehensive overview of school sports, its educational, social and recreational importance, and its role in reducing social problems and enhancing students' health.

Define terminology

Violence: is behavior aimed at causing harm or pain to another living being, and is considered an expression of power and control. This type of behavior involves a destructive activity by which an individual

harms others, whether through physical wounds or mockery and ridicule.

Verbal violence: This type is limited to the use of words, where the use of the body is not clear. It may manifest as yelling or offensive language, and usually includes insults or curses and mentioning negative qualities about others.

Physical violence: Here the body becomes a means of expressing aggression, as people benefit from their physical strength to injure others, and includes the use of hands, nails, and legs as tools of aggression.

Symbolic violence: It includes behavior that indicates contempt for others or engaging in behaviors that lead to insult, such as not looking at or ignoring the person.

- **School sports:** Out-of-curricular sports activities, or sports in schools, are one of the essential elements for achieving educational goals. It includes a range of different activities, whether individual or group, organized by sports federations, associations and school cultural societies.

Social ills: These are considered among the greatest challenges facing societies, as social health is a topic of global importance due to the spread of harmful customs and traditions among members of society across generations.

- **Addiction attacks:** All types of drugs, regardless of their nature or social context, pose a significant risk. The resulting damage, whether direct or indirect, hinders society and harms its values, stability, security and livelihood. Drugs that pose an immediate danger show a lot of harm, but drugs that may seem less dangerous, such as cigarettes and alcohol, may be more destructive, more effective, and more widespread.

Smoking: Smoking is considered the major starting point or gateway that opens the door for young people into the world of drugs. It may prompt young people to want to smoke to express themselves and challenge themselves, giving them a feeling of euphoria that they seek to achieve. However, poor smoking conditions, poor company with friends, and limited enjoyment from smoking may prompt some teenage smokers to look for other ways to achieve greater orgasm. At this point, they become willing to try additional drugs.

- **Physical health:** means the safety of all body organs and the existence of complete harmony between the various organic functions, as each organ performs its role with complete efficiency. It is also defined as the body's ability to confront diseases and changes, and its ability to adapt to the circumstances it is going through. Good health includes perfection in physical, mental and social aspects, and is not only

the absence of disease or disability (*WHO 2010*).

The method followed

The nature of the problem being analyzed determines the type of method the researcher uses. In this study, the method used is the descriptive method, which aims to study the phenomenon of non-classroom sports activities and their role in protecting against social problems and promoting physical health.

Community and research sample

The study population is the complete set of elements to which the researcher wishes to generalize the results in relation to the problem studied. Our study population consists of physical education and sports teachers who are members of the State School Sports Association. The research sample includes twenty teachers, representing 9% of the study population.

Tool design

The questionnaire form was divided into four axes to address the hypotheses presented:

The first axis addresses the issue of violence in schools, dealing with the first hypothesis: "Non-prescriptive sports activities play an important role in combating all forms of violence in schools." His questions include 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6.

The second axis revolves around the issue of drug prevention and addresses the first hypothesis: "Extracurricular sports activity plays a positive role in preventing students from using drugs in schools". It includes his questions 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, and 12.

The third axis addresses the second hypothesis: "Non-prescriptive sports activity represents a means of reducing cigarette smoking in schools." Questions in this section include 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, and 18.

The fourth axis focuses on the physical health of students, discussing the third hypothesis: "Sports activity plays a positive role in maintaining the physical health of students participating in school sports activities". His questions contain the numbers 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, and 24.

Statistical method

The results were analyzed by percentage and the sufficient squared test was applied.

Analyze and discuss the results

Analysis and discussion of the results of the first axis: Violence in the school environment:

The results of the questions related to the first axis of the questionnaire showed that extracurricular activities contribute significantly to reducing violence in all its forms. This is done by investing time in training and sports competitions, which helps the student achieve energy release. In

addition, outstanding athletes, even in school sports, feel a sense of self-worth and balanced personality development. This makes them pay more attention to their appearance and behavior, as others' attention is directed towards them. (Boyle) pointed out that sports are considered a basic need for humans, as they contribute to freeing them from the "aggressive instinct." Therefore, practicing sports activity in general is a way to relieve stress. (Anwar Al-Khouly 1996, 48)

Analysis and discussion of the results of the second axis: drug prevention:

The results of the questionnaire applied in the second axis showed that sports in schools contribute to reducing drug use in all its forms. This is due to its noble goals that meet students' social and psychological needs, such as the need for belonging, friendship, self-realization and recognition. Sports also help students overcome problems of anxiety and isolation that can lead to unacceptable behaviors that compensate them for spiritual emptiness, so to speak. In addition, it contributes to utilizing leisure time in a way that benefits students, society, and the environment. Sport also promotes positive social values such as cooperation, fair competition, community service and the public interest. Therefore, we can confirm that extracurricular sports activity plays a role in preventing drug abuse. Therefore, it can be said that the first hypothesis has been realized.

Analysis and discussion of the results of the third axis: Reducing smoking:

By studying the results of the questions related to the third axis, it appears to us that practicing non-classroom sports activities aims to instill positive qualities derived from the teachings of our true religion in the souls of students through purposeful programs and activities. These activities also help in discovering talents and abilities, developing them and enhancing them to be beneficial to the individual and society. It also contributes to shaping the student's personality and helps reduce all forms of violence.

Therefore, engaging in sports activities outside the classroom leads to a reduction in smoking. Hence, we conclude that the second hypothesis has been verified and is confirmed by the results of multiple studies.

Analysis and discussion of the results of the fourth axis: students' physical health:

By studying the results of the questions related to this axis, it appears to us that non-classroom sports activities aim to improve the physical and mental health of students participating in various areas of this type of activity. This is done by discovering, developing and refining physical skills and abilities with the aim of employing them to serve the individual and society, and working to develop them by reaching the specific goals of each non-class sports

activity. It also contributes to raising the health level and achieving physical development for students through planned individual and group activities. Therefore, we can say that the third hypothesis has been proven.

General conclusion

By analyzing and discussing the results related to the four-axis questions, which include the general hypothesis, we can conclude that extracurricular sports activity depends on two main foundations: education and the social aspect. This activity aims to eliminate violence in all its forms, whether material, moral or symbolic, directed either towards educational or administrative bodies or even towards students themselves. This type of activity also seeks to achieve and develop values, as Johnson points out in 1966 that engaging in sports in general promotes a system of universally recognized values.

In 1966, Tolman believed that the focus of attention on sports in schools affects the subculture of adolescents, and he found that adolescents can represent their peers better through sports than through other subjects. Coakley pointed out some of the positive benefits of exercise for teenagers, such as enhancing sportsmanship, cooperation, acceptance of others, self-discipline, and social development, in addition to being an outlet for youth energy.

When a student participates in extracurricular activities, he or she has the opportunity to introduce himself or herself in a more clear way, enhancing his or her sense of being an individual with diverse talents and abilities. Close communication with colleagues and members of the opposing team enables one to gain a better understanding of human behavior in situations that vary between calm and emotional. This increases his knowledge of his individuals and his community.

Moreover, during sports competitions or civic activities, students are exposed to the practice of many of the values of democratic life, such as respect for the rights of others, laws, non-discrimination, cooperation, and respect for competitors.

Education on responsibility and citizenship is part of this activity, as the student learns to respect himself, the rules, and the competitor, and sports activities encourage group participation and prioritize the concept of a team. These activities also contribute to physical development and health promotion through individual and group activities.

Therefore, it can be said that extracurricular sports activity is of great benefit in investing students' free time in a way that benefits them and society. It meets their social and psychological needs, such as the need for belonging, friendship, self-actualization, and self-esteem, helping

them address some of the problems related to anxiety, isolation, and social ills.

Accordingly, extracurricular sports activity is one of the effective ways to prevent addiction, whether through drugs, smoking, etc., and it also enhances students' physical health, especially if it is properly organized according to the determinants of the activity. Therefore, we confirm that the general hypothesis has been achieved.

Conclusion

The main social and educational role of sports activity outside of school is as a means of transmitting moral and cultural values, and a tool for guiding the behavior of individuals. This activity, within the framework of this mission, is also considered an element in strengthening solidarity and national unity by providing suitable conditions for students. In addition, it is a factor in developing discipline, a spirit of cooperation, responsibility and a sense of civic duties. Through this mission, this type of activity can become a source of entertainment and increase physical and cultural wealth, creating an atmosphere of joy and enthusiasm through the various activities it offers students that take advantage of their free time and provide forms of entertainment, which helps to stay away from all manifestations of violence and social problems, whether smoking, drugs, or otherwise.

Suggestions

- The necessity of activating the role of extracurricular sports activity in its social and educational aspect;
- The necessity of writing a purposeful and precise program according to the available capabilities;
- Giving real educational and social importance to extracurricular sports activity

References

- Amin Anwar Al-Khouly, Dr. Adnan Idris Jalloun, Dr. Mahmoud A. Al-Fattah Adnan: "School Physical Education, Classroom Teacher's Guide and Scientific Education Student", Dar Al-Fikr Al-Arabi, 3rd edition, 1994
- Muhammad Adel Khattab: "Physical Education for Social Service," Dar Al Nahda Al Arabiya, Cairo, 1965
- Muhammad Awad Bassiouni, Faisal Yassin Al-Shati: "Theories and Methods of Physical Education and Sports", 2nd ed., Office of University Publications, Algeria, 1992
- Hamed Abdel Salam Zahran: "Developmental Psychology, Childhood and Adolescence," Alam El-Kotob, Cairo. 1972
- Samuel Garius: "Mental Health and School Work," 2nd ed., Egyptian Renaissance Library, Cairo, 1974
- Adel Khattab, Kamal Zaki: "Physical Education for Social Service", Dar Al Nahda Al Arabiya, Cairo, 1987
- Abbas Mahmoud Awad: "Social Psychology", Dar Al Nahda Al Arabiya, Beirut, 1980
- Abdel Salam Abdel Ghaffar: "The Psychology of the Extraordinary Child," Dar Al Nahda Al Arabiya, Cairo, 1996
- Omar Muhammad Al-Shitani: "Psychological and Educational Foundations of Youth Care", House of Culture, Beirut, 1996

Legislation:

- Law 04/10 dated 27 Jumada II 1425 corresponding to August 14, 2004 relating to physical education and sports.
- Order 95/09 dated 25 Ramadan 1415 AH corresponding to 25 February 1995 relating to the direction and organization of the national system of physical education and sports.